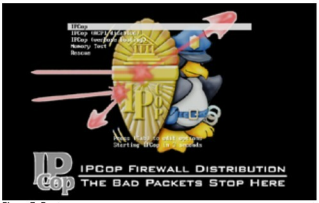

Figure 7: Boot screen

Figure 9: Updating 2.0.3 to 2.0.4

install the current version, you have to use the ISO for version 2.0.3, then upgrade to the latest one.)

- Install IPCop 2.0.3.
- Upgrade to IPCop 2.0.4.

A recommended best practice: Use a different hard disk to install the new version, if possible. This will give you a fall-back arrangement if you decide to go back to the old version for some reason.

Configure IPCop 2.0.4 to match the earlier IPCop and add-on settings:

If you have decided to go for the new version, have the ISO for IPCop 2.0.3 ready. Here are the installation steps and screen-shots to guide you. The steps are divided into three stages: installation, configuration and Web-based configuration.

Installation

Start the installation by booting from the IPCop CD. The first screen greets you with the IPCop mission statement: 'The bad packets stop here'; press *Enter* at the *boot:* prompt. Select the desired language; an information dialogue box tells you that pressing *'Cancel'* will reboot the system. Continue by clicking *OK*. Select the type of keyboard, the time zone, and enter the correct date and time, if required. Select the hard disk on which to install IPCop. Beware that all data on this disk will be erased. Then press *OK* to continue.

Here, a very interesting screen greets you, irrespective of whether the installation is on the hard disk or on flash (see the box for more details). Select the desired disk type. The installer will make the required file systems and swap space; ask whether you have an older back-up to be restored and complete the installation.

Figure 8: Web based https interface on port 8443

Configuration

Reboot the system to continue to configure the box. Enter the host name, domain name, select the RED Internet interface type and Ethernet cards. Note that here you can configure any Ethernet card to any interface. In the earlier version, the first detected Ethernet was assigned to GREEN always, and it was tricky to change it later. Also, to identify the card easily, you can set it in 'LED blinking on' mode. Assign GREEN and RED cards, and enter the GREEN IP address and subnet mask. You may enable DHCP if desired, and enter *root*, *admin* and *backup* passwords to complete the configuration part.

Web-based configuration

Reboot the system and wait till you see the *ipcop login:* screen (which can be used to log in as the *root* user). Use a client computer browser to open *https://IPCopIP:8443*, and authenticate with your username and password. The first step is to upgrade from 2.0.3 to 2.0.4. Download the binaries from the IPCop website, upload the file in the *System—Update* page, and click on *Apply Now* to upgrade.

Complete the set-up by configuring the Internet. This trial set-up uses PPPoE on the RED interface. Proceed to *Network—Dialup*, enter the PPPoE username and password. From *System—Home* connect to the Internet. Configure the IPCop GREEN IP as the default gateway and DNS in the client TCP/IP settings; and that is all... you can start browsing securely.

Watch out for further articles on configuring the IPCop 2.0.x distro! END

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